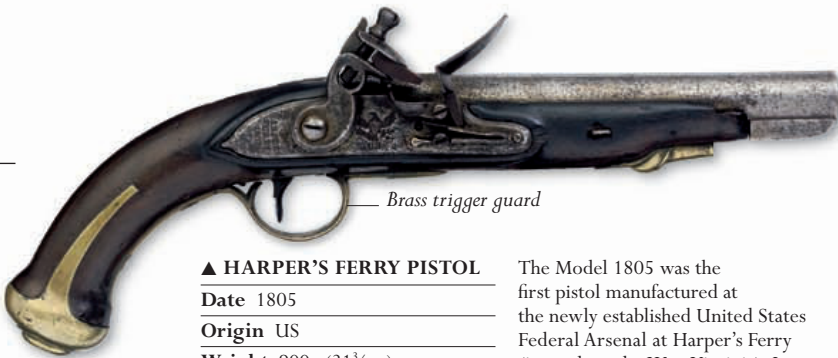


FLINTLOCK AND PERCUSSION PISTOLS AND EARLY REVOLVERS

American Samuel Colt patented the design of a new type of pistol in 1835 – a six-shot cylinder revolver that fired percussion-cap ammunition. Colt was the first manufacturer to prove that it was commercially viable to mass-produce revolvers – no fewer than 215,348 of his .36 calibre Model 1851 revolver were sold from 1851 to 1876. British interest in pistols was sparked by Colt’s display at the Great Exhibition of 1851 in London. By the end of the 1850s, revolvers made by London gunmakers such as Robert Adams had become more popular in Britain than American Colts. Adams’s pistols had double-action (“self-cocking”) locks – an element of British revolver design from the start.



▲ HARPER'S FERRY PISTOL

Date	1805
Origin	US
Weight	900g (31¼oz)
Barrel	25.4cm (10in)
Calibre	.54in

The Model 1805 was the first pistol manufactured at the newly established United States Federal Arsenal at Harper's Ferry (in modern-day West Virginia). It was robust enough to be reversed and used as a club if required.



▲ COLT PATERSON REVOLVING RIFLE

Date	1837
Origin	US
Weight	3.9kg (8½lb)
Barrel	81.3cm (32in)
Calibre	.36in

Samuel Colt's first factory in Paterson, New Jersey, produced revolver rifles as well as pistols. However, it had limited facilities and went bankrupt. Paterson-built Colts, such as this first-pattern concealed-hammer eight-shot rifle, are extremely rare.

► PATTERN 1842 COAST GUARD PISTOL

Date	1842
Origin	UK
Weight	1.05kg (2¼lb)
Barrel	15cm (6in)
Calibre	24-bore

In the 1842 coast guard pistol, the ramrod retainer swivelled to allow the captive rod to be inserted in the barrel. These pistols were replaced by revolvers from the 1850s.



Plain unfluted cylinder has eight chambers

Hammer

Ramrod retainer

Lock plate



▲ COLT POCKET PISTOL MODEL 1849

Date	1849
Origin	US
Weight	690g (24½oz)
Barrel	10.2cm (4in)
Calibre	.31in

A revised version of his 1848 revolver, the Baby Dragoon, Samuel Colt's 1849 Pocket Pistol had a standard compound rammer, the choice of three barrel lengths, and a five- or six-shot cylinder.

Octagonal barrel



Brass trigger guard

Cutaway to facilitate placing of cap

Brass-bound butt



▲ COLT SECOND MODEL DRAGOON PISTOL

Date	1849
Origin	US
Weight	1.93kg (4¼lb)
Barrel	19cm (7½in)
Calibre	.44in

Colt's mainstay during the first 15 years of the percussion era was the Dragoon Pistol, so called because it was intended as a side-arm for cavalymen. A new factory was built at Hartford in Connecticut to produce the Dragoon Pistol to fulfil an army contract.

▲ COLT NAVY MODEL 1851

Date	1853
Origin	UK
Weight	1.2kg (2½lb)
Barrel	19cm (7½in)
Calibre	.36in

At the Great Exhibition of 1851 in London, Samuel Colt introduced the Navy Model, a lighter pistol in .36in rather than .44in calibre. After the display, he obtained an order from the British government. This is one of the pistols produced at the company's London factory.